

MED//25
TERM 2 · 2026
DIVINE ETHICS



Divine ethics

sincerity · trust · remembrance · gratitude · prayer
· repentance



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DIVINE ETHICS
EXAM REVIEW

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

In the Name of God, the Most compassionate, the Most Merciful

SUPPLICATION BEFORE STUDY

اللَّهُمَّ أَخْرِجْنِي مِنْ ظُلُمَاتِ الْوَهْمِ، وَأَكْرِمْنِي بِنُورِ الْفَهْمِ، اللَّهُمَّ افْتَحْ عَلَيْنَا
أَبْوَابَ رَحْمَتِكَ، وَأَنْشُرْ عَلَيْنَا خَزَائِنَ عُلُومِكَ، بِرَحْمَتِكَ يَا أَرْحَمَ الرَّاحِمِينَ

O God, bring me out of the darkness of doubt and honour me with the light of understanding. O
God, open to us the doors of Your mercy and spread over us the treasures of Your knowledge, by
Your mercy, O Most Merciful of the merciful.

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَآلِ مُحَمَّدٍ

O God, send blessings upon Muhammad and the family of Muhammad.

أَلَا بِذِكْرِ اللَّهِ تَطْمَئِنُّ الْقُلُوبُ

Verily, in the remembrance of God do hearts find rest. (al-Ra'd 13:28)

Prelude

In the Name of God

All praise belongs to God, Lord of the worlds, and blessings be upon Muhammad and his pure Household. This review was made to make the study of ethics a little easier: not only to pass an examination, but to keep close the qualities that make a physician trustworthy and a heart at peace.

The Imams of the Household of the Prophet (a.s.) taught that knowledge is not only something we collect, but a light that God places in the heart.

الْعِلْمُ نُورٌ يَقْذِفُهُ اللَّهُ فِي قَلْبٍ مَنْ يَشَاءُ

"Knowledge is a light that God casts into the heart of whomever He wills."

Attributed to Imam Ja'far al-Ṣādiq (a.s.)

Medicine has its own place in that tradition. Imam 'Alī ibn Mūsā al-Riḍā (a.s.) wrote *al-Risāla al-Dhahabiyya*, the Golden Treatise, on the body, its balance and the keeping of health. It was written at the request of al-Ma'mūn, and tradition records that it was called golden because he ordered it to be written in gold ink. It is a reminder that studying the body carefully is a way of honouring its Maker.

Whatever is correct in these pages is from God; whatever is mistaken is mine. May it benefit everyone who studies from it, and may it be counted as knowledge that benefits.

On the shoulders of giants

This book is built on the Divine Ethics reference pages and on the teaching of our professor. It rests on the scholars who preserved these teachings and on everyone who studied before us and wrote it down. If we see a little further, it is only because we stand on the shoulders of giants. Thank you.



SMR

Rizzist

Syed-Mohammad Raza

At a glance

what is in this review

Planning, sincerity, trust and remembrance

Start here: source and course map · Planning, organization and time · Sincerity, ostentation and means · Seven practices for sincerity · Trust in God with effort · Remembrance of the heart

Gratitude, prayer and repentance

Gratitude: recognition, speech and action · Gratitude: obstacles and distinctions · Prayer, effort and a wise response · Immediate repentance and moral development

Integrated review

Integrated distinctions for revision

coral topics and ideas to learn

blue → clinical relevance

red pen an error in the class notes, corrected



Test yourself: MED25 practice questions, answers upside down

11 topics · 55 ideas · 41 figures · 0 corrections to the class notes. Built from the Divine Ethics reference pages (September 2026), the only course source. Diagrams are generated, symbolic teaching illustrations; Quranic verses and narrations are quoted as text with their references.

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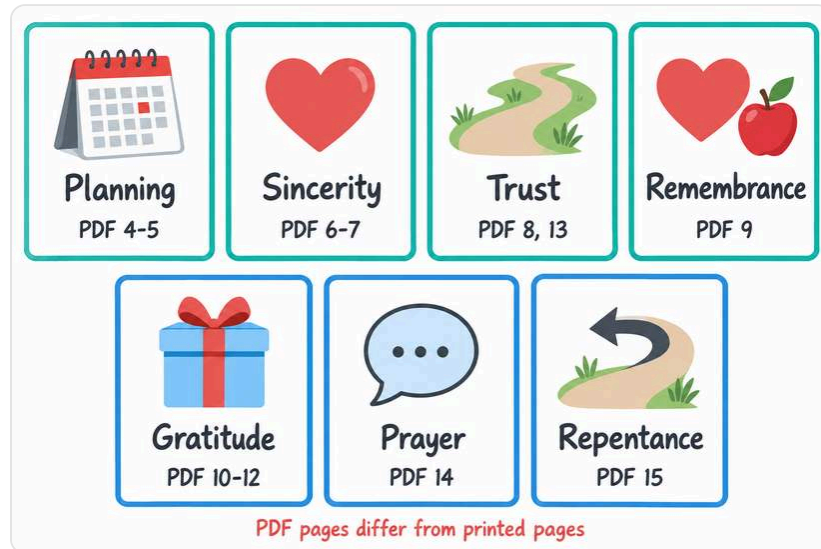
INTEGRATED REVIEW

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Start here: source and course map

Use the actual teaching pages for revision; contents headings locate the wider book but do not supply missing lessons.

Navigate the supplied packet



- The PDF contains three contents pages and twelve teaching pages, arranged out of printed-page order.
- Citations distinguish one-based PDF pages from the page numbers printed in the book.
- Begin with the topic map below; each row identifies the teaching pages actually supplied.
- The foundations sections cover planning, sincerity, trust and remembrance; the practice sections cover gratitude, prayer and repentance.

Fig. 1 Seven topics connect the supplied teaching pages to the review sections.

Where each supplied topic belongs

TOPIC	PDF PAGES	PRINTED PAGES	REVIEW DESTINATION
Planning and organization	4-5	59-60	sep17-planning
Sincerity and ostentation	6-7	56, 58	sep17-ostentation; sep17-sincerity-practice
Trust in God	8, 13	52, 54	sep17-trust
Remembrance and the apple case	9	32	sep17-remembrance
Thankfulness: levels, effects and obstacles	10-12	46, 47, 49	sep17-gratitude-levels; sep17-gratitude-obstacles
Prayer, effort and answers	14	40	sep17-prayer; effort also informs sep17-trust
Immediate repentance and habits	15	35	sep17-repentance

Locate the wider book without inventing missing lessons

- Contents page 1 places self-building, piety, remembrance and repentance within Individual Ethics.
- Contents page 2 adds prayer, thankfulness, trust, sincerity, and planning and organization.
- Contents page 3 continues planning, then maps Social Ethics: rights, wishing good, helping, self-sacrifice, manners and restraining anger.
- Detailed lists absent from the teaching scans cannot be reconstructed from contents headings alone.

Know the limits of the supplied source

- The contents mention levels of intention, but printed page 57 is absent; no numbered intention hierarchy is supplied.
- Printed page 60 supplies four good-plan characteristics, although the contents direct that heading to page 61.
- Foundations narrations appear in English only; the sincerity phrase appears in transliteration, without an Arabic-script original.
- Prayer page 40 contains Arabic Qur'anic excerpts omitted by the OCR; quoted Arabic must be checked against that image.

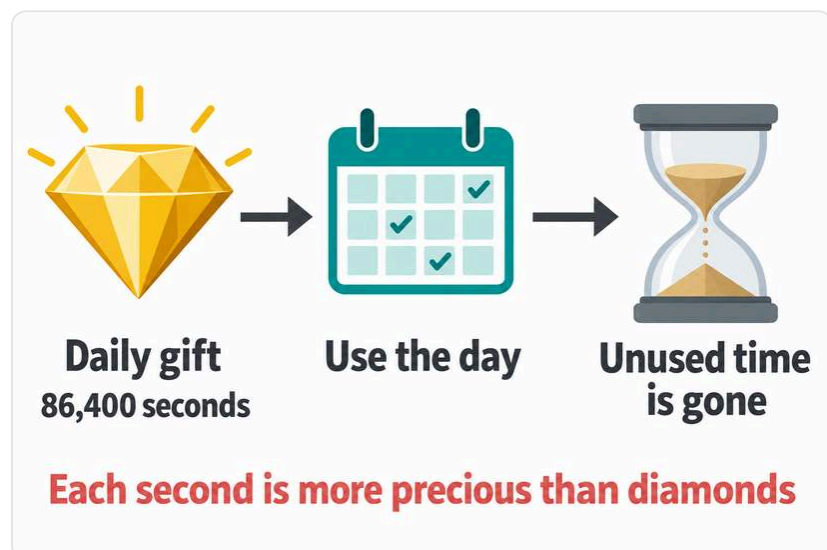
Planning, Sincerity, trust and remembrance

02

Planning, organization and time

A finite life requires a sound plan, timely implementation, reflection and balanced responsibilities.

Every day brings 86,400 irreplaceable seconds



- The imagined bank provides 86,400 kilograms of diamonds each day and withdraws everything left unspent.
- Likewise, each day provides 86,400 seconds that will never be given again.
- The source values each second above a kilogram of diamonds.
- Limited life enables material and spiritual perfection and success in this world and the next.

Fig. 2 The diamond-bank analogy emphasizes the irretrievable value of each day.

Planning prepares; organization implements

- Planning conceptualizes and prepares a good plan.
- Organization implements the plan and secures its success.
- Imam Ali: "The subsistence of life depends upon proper planning, and the means to achieve this is proper organization".

Planning and organization

TERM	ROLE
Planning	Conceptualize and prepare the plan.
Organization	Implement the plan and secure its success.

Four principles of planning



Fig. 3 The source gives four complementary principles for planning.

- 1. Time management: allocate time according to needs and priorities.
- 2. Implementation: recognize the proper time, rank tasks, and act appropriately.
- 3. Reflection: examine experience and consider the present and future before acting.
- 4. Mentors and advice: consult knowledgeable, experienced people, including parents, religious scholars and specialist counsellors.
- Parents know your abilities and have more experience; other advisers should bring relevant knowledge, experience and planning expertise.

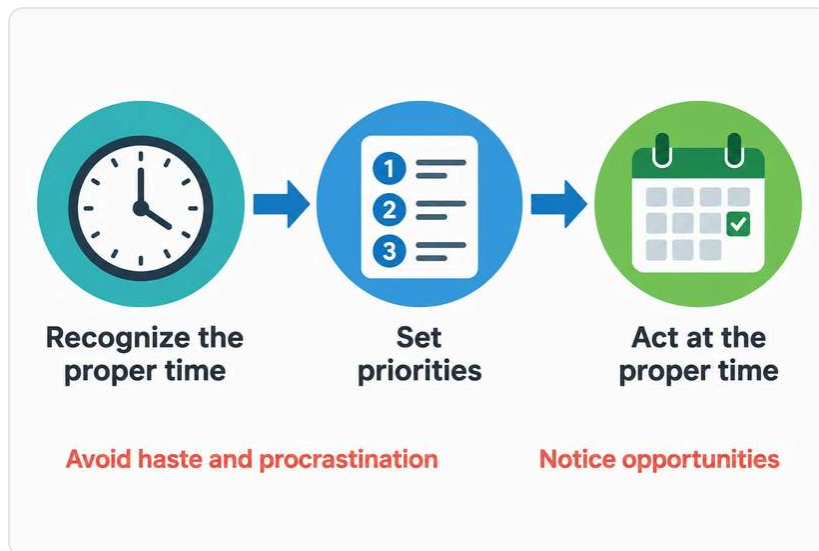
Divide time among three needs



Fig. 4 Daily time serves worship, livelihood and permitted rest without requiring equal durations.

- 1. Connection with God: worship, prayer and religious obligations.
- 2. Work and daily effort: obtain life's provisions.
- 3. Rest, leisure and pleasures permitted by religion.
- The periods need not be equal; their lengths follow needs and priorities.

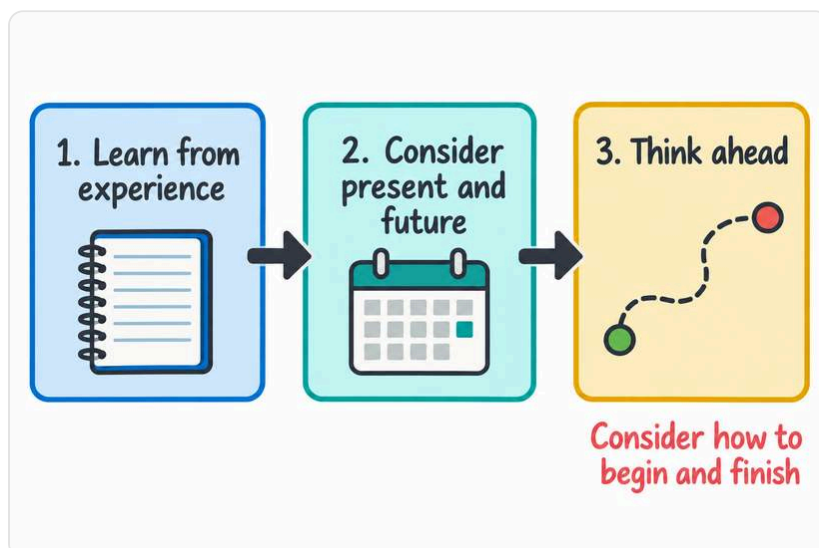
Implement at the proper time



- 1. Recognize the proper time for each task.
- 2. Categorize tasks according to priority.
- 3. Implement at the appropriate time, avoiding haste and procrastination; remain alert to opportunities.
- The Prophet: "Every task depends upon its performance at its proper time".

Fig. 5 Recognition, priority and timely action make implementation effective.

Reflect before beginning



- 1. Examine and analyze your past experience and the experience of others.
- 2. Pay attention to the present and future.
- 3. Think ahead about how an action will begin and end, before regret follows.
- Hadith, exact excerpt: "Before doing something, think about it for a while".

Fig. 6 Reflection draws on experience and looks ahead before action.

Four characteristics visible in the scan



- 1. Define goals clearly and identify which have priority.
- 2. Make each step support the goal; the plan's means and ends should agree.
- 3. Be comprehensive: prioritize all responsibilities, activities and necessary requirements.
- 4. Maintain moderation and balance between capabilities and desires; needs shape goals, and capabilities enable achievement.

Fig. 7 The supplied page lists clarity, alignment, comprehensiveness and balance.

Keep each task in its proper place and time



- Imam Ali's letter warns against haste before the proper time and laziness when a task can be done.
- It also warns against stubbornness about important things and laxity about clear and evident matters.
- Exact excerpt: "Perform every task in its own proper place, and do everything at its own time".

Fig. 8 Four cautions accompany the instruction to act in the proper place and time.

Plan for material and spiritual growth

- Human existence is unified but has material and spiritual dimensions.
- Planning and organization should take both dimensions seriously.
- Imam al-Baqir rejects laziness in worldly affairs and connects it with greater laziness regarding the afterlife.
- Exact excerpt: "I do not like the person who is lazy with regards to his worldly affairs."

Test yourself

1. A plan has clear goals and a complete timetable, but most scheduled activities do not advance those goals. Which visible characteristic is most directly missing?
 - A. Harmony between the plan's steps and its goals
 - B. Recognition that time is finite
 - C. A larger number of scheduled tasks
 - D. Equal allocation to every activity
2. A student insists that the three recommended daily periods must each last exactly eight hours. What is the best correction?
 - A. The source requires equal periods but permits shorter days
 - B. Rest should always be removed before the other periods change
 - C. Only the work period may be planned
 - D. Their duration should follow needs and priorities; equality is not required
3. Which sequence most closely matches the source's account of implementation?
 - A. Recognize suitable timing, prioritize tasks, and perform them at the appropriate time
 - B. Perform the easiest task first and never revise that order
 - C. Wait for complete certainty about every possible outcome
 - D. Define goals but avoid taking action until the next review

Answers: 1 A · 2 D · 3 A

Planning, sincerity, trust and remembrance

03

Sincerity, ostentation and means

The intention behind an outwardly good act determines whether it is sincere or directed toward worldly approval.

Sincerity and ostentation concern the motive

Sincerity	Ostentation
 For God	 For worldly approval
 Good outward action	 Good outward action
 Purified intention	 Poisoned deed
Examine the motive behind the act	

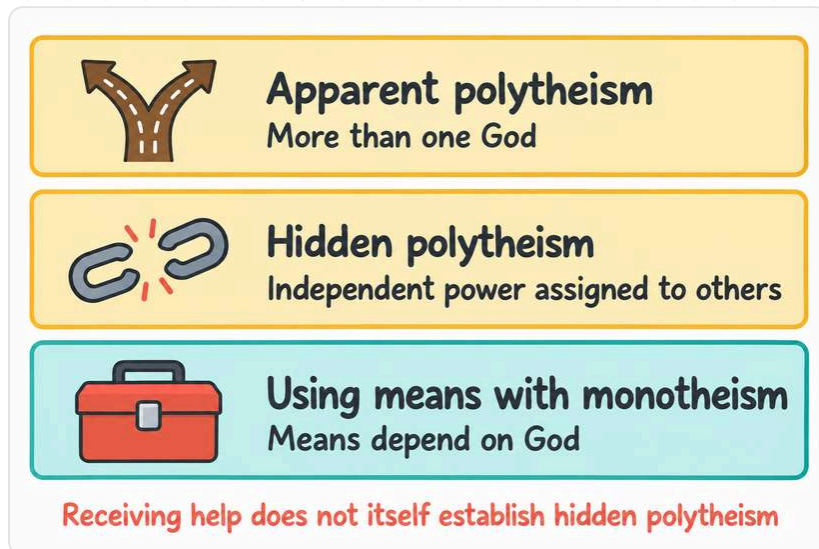
- Sincerity (ikhlas) purifies actions of every non-divine intention.
- Ostentation (riya) seeks worldly benefits through worship or good deeds, such as money, status or praise.
- An outwardly correct action can still be spiritually poisonous when its motive is ostentation.
- Sincerity has many levels and is described as the highest and most desirable level of worship.

Fig. 9 The same outward action can carry different intentions and spiritual effects.

The outward act is not enough

FEATURE	SINCERITY	OSTENTATION
Aim	Purify intention for God.	Acquire worldly benefits or others' approval.
Outward action	May be worship or another good action.	May appear to be the same good action.
Inner effect	The source's highest, most desirable level of worship.	Nullifies and poisons the deed; harms the soul.

Distinguish hidden polytheism from using means



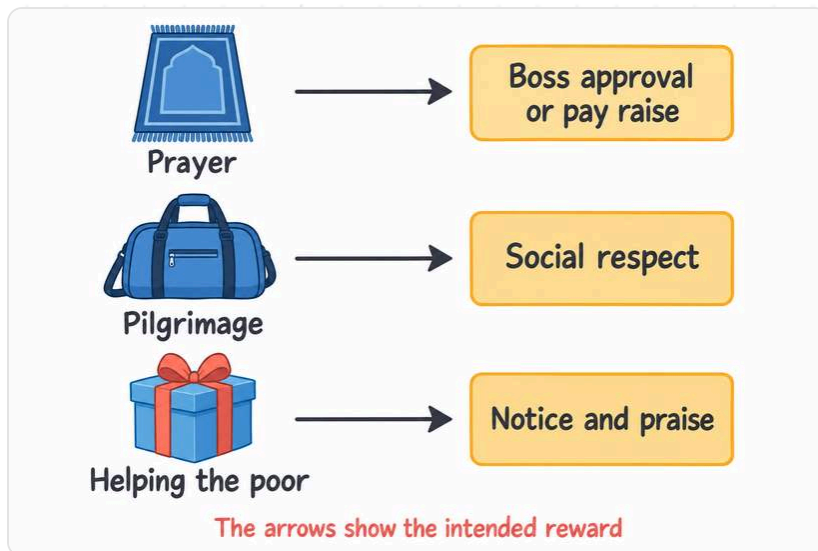
- Apparent polytheism believes in more than one God and includes worship of beings other than God.
- Hidden polytheism affirms one God but attributes independent power to other beings; the source links it to weak faith and obliviousness.
- A monotheist may use others' help while recognizing that no being independently supplies needs.
- Worship seeking something other than God's pleasure contains a degree of hidden polytheism.

Fig. 10 Using means is distinguished from believing that those means act independently.

Belief and dependence

POSITION	DECISIVE FEATURE
Apparent polytheism	Belief in more than one God; worship directed to other beings.
Hidden polytheism	Belief in one God while attributing independent effectiveness to other beings.
Using means with monotheism	Seek help and use causes while recognizing their dependence on God.

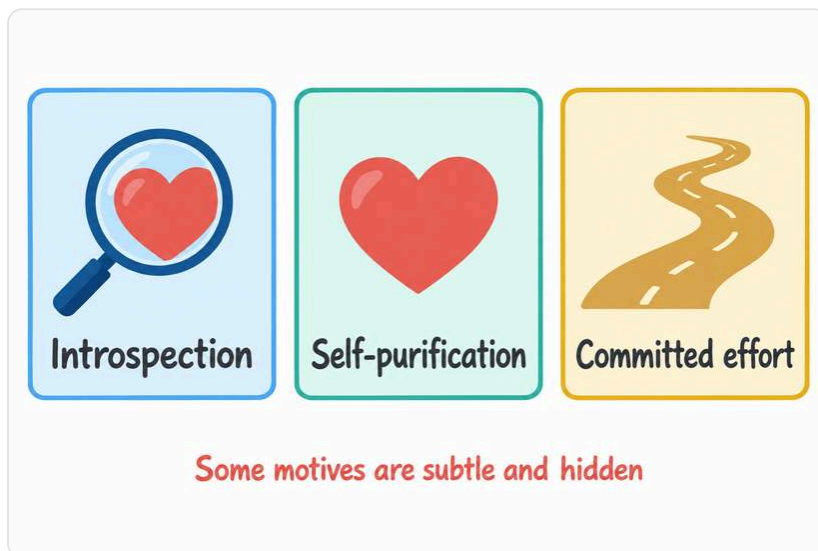
Recognize ostentation by its intended reward



- Praying to gain the boss's affection or a pay raise directs worship toward worldly advantage.
- Performing pilgrimage to gain other people's respect seeks social standing.
- Helping the poor to attract notice and praise seeks an audience's approval.

Fig. 11 The source identifies three apparently good actions distorted by the reward sought.

Subtle ostentation requires inner work



- Some forms of ostentation are complex and hidden.
- Identify and address them through introspection, self-purification and committed effort.
- Each person is responsible for the duty corresponding to their level of faith.

Fig. 12 Recognizing subtle ostentation requires reflection, purification and commitment.

Test yourself

1. A believer borrows equipment while regarding the lender and equipment as means dependent on God. Does the source's definition alone make this hidden polytheism?
 - A. Yes; only cash loans are allowed as dependent means
 - B. No; human means must therefore be independent of God
 - C. No; the defining problem is attributing independent efficacy, not merely using a means
 - D. Yes; all human assistance is classified as worship
2. The supplied conclusion says sincerity has levels, while the contents list a separate page on levels of intention. What can this extract establish?
 - A. Every intention is equally sincere if behavior is identical
 - B. That sincerity has degrees, but not a complete unseen taxonomy of intention
 - C. A precise complete hierarchy can be inferred from the heading alone
 - D. The source denies differences in sincerity
3. A person prays primarily to impress a supervisor and obtain a raise. Which source example does this most closely match?
 - A. Practical gratitude through service
 - B. Using ordinary causes without any ulterior motive
 - C. Worship used to obtain worldly advantage through display
 - D. Planning the appropriate time for work

Answers: 1 C • 2 B • 3 C

Planning, sincerity, trust and remembrance

04

Seven practices for sincerity

Retain the source's numbering: love, impermanence, danger, concealment, fasting, discreet remembrance and responsibility.

Seven ways to cultivate sincerity



- The seven numbered practices below reproduce the source's order.
- The source's preferred route is love of God, cultivated by recognizing His blessings and beautiful attributes and obeying His commands.
- Sincerity has many levels; actions should be purified of every non-divine intention.
- The recitation phrase is printed as "la ilaha illa Allah"; its Arabic-script wording is not supplied on this page.

Fig. 13 Seven numbered practices cultivate sincerity and counter ostentation.

The seven practices and their reasons

NO.	PRACTICE	REASON OR APPLICATION GIVEN IN THE SOURCE
1	Love God.	Pure love frees a person from other attachments and directs ambitions toward the beloved.
2	Contemplate that everything other than God will perish.	Do not prefer fragile creatures' benefits over the eternal God who witnesses actions; graves, death and unexpected accidents prompt reflection.
3	Understand the harm of ostentation.	It nullifies and poisons the deed; it is negative, not neutral, and gradually leads toward polytheism.
4	Conceal acts of worship.	Avoid recounting worship enabled by divine help, even to close friends or family.
5	Practice sincerity through fasting.	Unless the person discloses the fast, others do not know about it.
6	Recite la ilaha illa Allah.	Its monotheistic content enriches sincerity; the source says the lips do not meet and only the tongue moves, allowing discreet recitation.
7	Recognize obedience and avoiding prohibitions as your responsibility.	Their benefits return to you; do not expect something from other people for fulfilling this responsibility.

Test yourself

- A person deliberately avoids advertising a voluntary act of worship. Which recommended practice is being used?
 - Concealing worship as an exercise against showing off
 - Seeking praise from a smaller and more exclusive audience
 - Proving that all publicly performed worship is invalid
 - Replacing all obligations with secrecy itself
- Which pair correctly matches a practice to the tendency it addresses?
 - Recognizing harm makes display neutral; fulfilling duty creates a debt from observers
 - Reflection on impermanence addresses fixation on transient approval; concealment reduces self-advertising
 - Fasting requires public admiration; concealment guarantees financial success
 - Love of God eliminates action; meaningful remembrance eliminates responsibility
- Why does the page recommend reflecting on impermanence when addressing ostentation?
 - It proves that current actions have no consequences
 - It removes the need to fulfill duties during life
 - It establishes that every relationship must be abandoned
 - It challenges the value placed on fleeting human status and approval

Answers: 1 A · 2 B · 3 D

Trust in God with effort

Tawakkul joins reliance on God to serious effort and the use of means whose effectiveness depends on Him.

What trust in God means here

- Trust in God (tawakkul) is a pillar of faith rooted in conviction in divine unity.
- It has degrees; one is entrusting all affairs to God.
- This includes satisfaction with what God intends and recognition of His command.
- Continue striving toward perfection while recognizing at every step that everything is from Him.

Trust never transfers away your responsibility

- Trust does not authorize handing responsibilities to God while remaining idle.
- The source criticizes idleness and unemployment without due reason, and urges the greatest effort one can make.
- Farmers stopped working and claimed reliance on God; the Prophet replied: "No. Rather, you are the lazy."

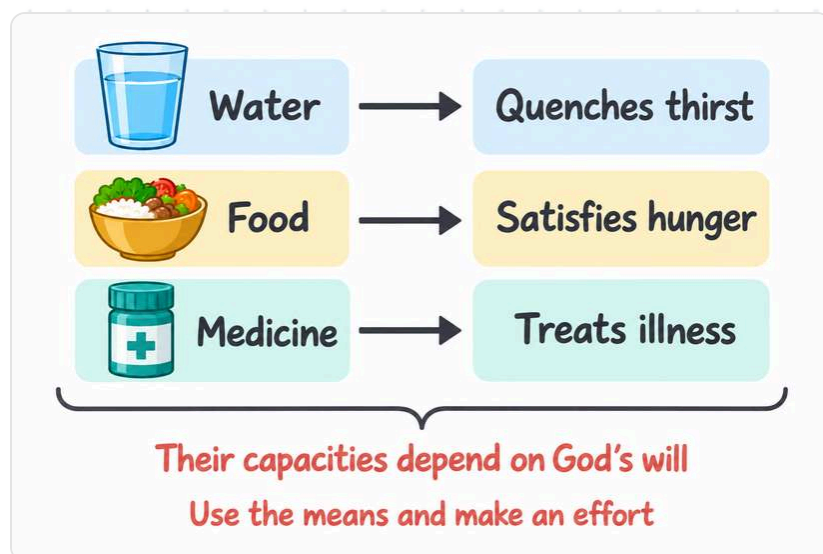
Why effort matters



- Effort allows life to be lived to the fullest.
- It allows continued testing by God.
- It enables potential powers to blossom.
- It contributes to the perfection of the individual and society.

Fig. 14 The source associates effort with fuller life, testing, developing potential and perfection.

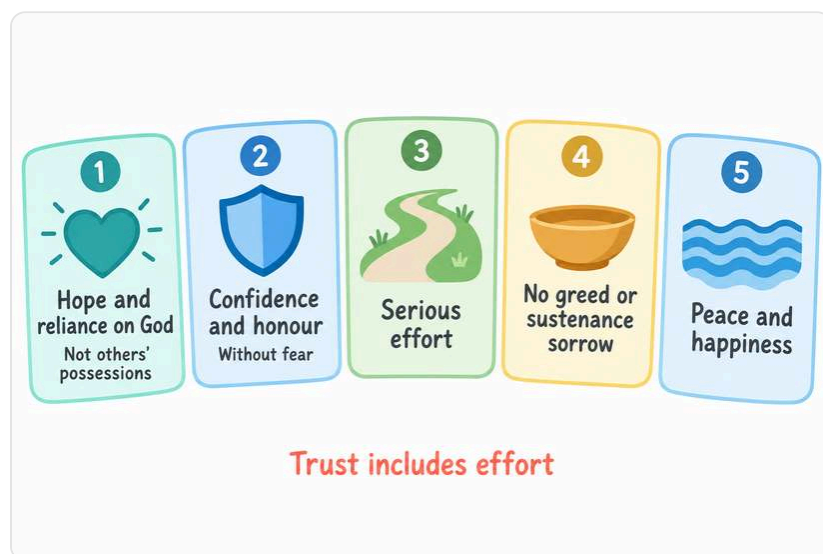
causes work through granted capacity



- Use natural causes and make an effort to reach goals; their effectiveness depends on God's will.
- Water quenches thirst through the capacity God has placed in it.
- Food satisfies hunger through the capacity God has placed in it.
- Medicine treats illness through the capacity God has placed in it; means do not independently satisfy needs.
- The source grounds this understanding in monotheism and certainty about God's existence and greatness.

Fig. 15 Water, food and medicine illustrate using effective means without attributing independence to them.

The five signs of trust



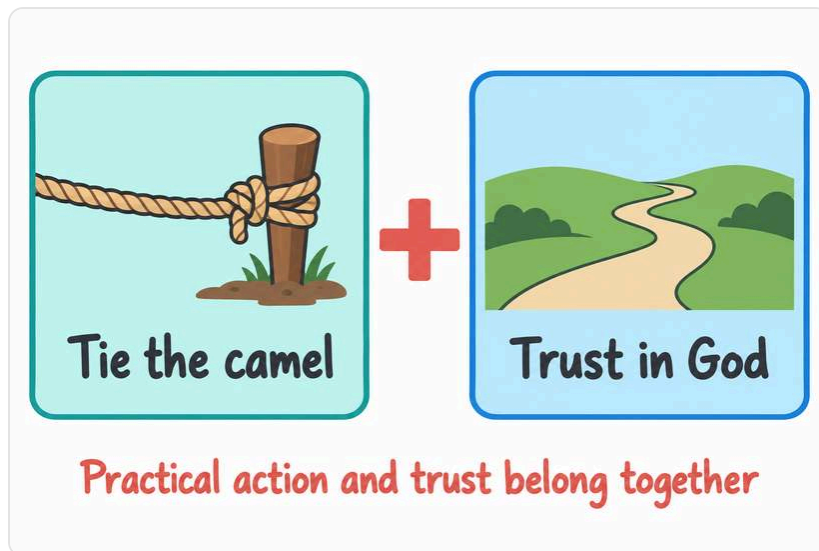
- 1. Think well of God, rely on Him, and hope in what He has; relinquish hope in others and their possessions.
- 2. Confidence with honour, without fear of others or difficulties.
- 3. Serious effort toward the goals of life.
- 4. Freedom from greed and sadness about one's sustenance.
- 5. Peace and happiness.

Fig. 16 The five signs include active effort as well as confidence, contentment and peace.

Read the signs with the teaching on means

POTENTIAL CONFUSION	SOURCE-GROUNDED DISTINCTION
Giving up hope in others	Give up independent reliance on others; using help and natural causes remains compatible with monotheism.
Being content about sustenance	Contentment accompanies serious effort; it does not excuse avoidable idleness.

Tie the camel and trust



- The man asked whether he should tie his camel or leave it free while trusting God.
- The Prophet replied: "Tie your camel with the trust in God."
- The narration keeps practical action and trust together.

Fig. 17 The camel narration joins practical precaution to trust in God.

Trust supports confidence in difficulty

- The Prophet: "If someone wants to be the strongest of people then he should trust in God."
- Imam Ali, exact excerpt: "Hardships will become easy for the person who trusts in God".
- The Imam Ali narration adds that means toward accomplishing goals will be placed at the person's disposal.

The umbrella at the prayer for rain



- During a drought, villagers asked their clergyman to lead the prayer for rain.
- A young man brought an umbrella when the villagers gathered for prayer.
- The clergyman identified his preparation as evidence of trust; the case asks whether professed belief appears in action.

Fig. 18 The umbrella story asks whether practical readiness matches professed trust.

Prayer accompanies effort and trust

- ادْعُونِي أَسْتَجِبْ لَكُمْ
- English meaning as printed: "Pray to Me; I will answer you" (Qur'an 40:60).
- Recognizing God as the source of benefits leads a person to ask Him for needs and then strive to attain them.
- Achievement strengthens faith through the experience of divine help.
- If the goal is not attained, the source counsels confidence that the beneficent God desires good for His servants.

Test yourself

1. How does the conclusion describe trust across one's affairs?

A. Trust concerns worship only and excludes ordinary life	B. Trust has degrees, including relying on God throughout one's affairs while continuing to strive
C. Trust has no degrees and is measured only by possessions	D. Greater trust necessarily means less responsibility
2. Which behavior is explicitly one of the five signs of trust on printed page 54?

A. Constant comparison with others' possessions	B. Serious effort toward the goals of life
C. Refusing every available human means	D. Waiting idly for goals to be achieved
3. Which set contains only signs named on the supplied trust page?

A. Neglect of duties, refusal of help and public display	B. Three equal time periods and a complete timetable
C. Hopeful reliance, dignified confidence, serious effort and peace	D. Guaranteed wealth, universal popularity and permanent ease

Answers: 1 B • 2 B • 3 C

Planning, sincerity, trust and remembrance

06

Remembrance of the heart

The apple case illustrates inward awareness; the conclusion places remembrance of the heart before verbal and practical benefit.

Remembrance begins with the heart

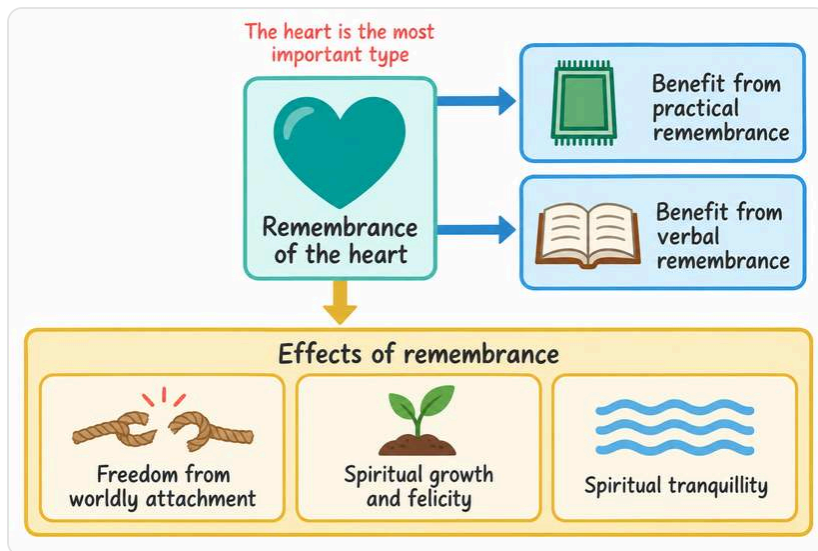


Fig. 19 Remembrance of the heart enables benefit from practical and verbal remembrance and supports spiritual growth and tranquillity.

- Remembrance of God is a divine gift that frees the heart from preoccupation with other things and attachment to the mundane.
- Remembrance of the heart is the most important type.
- It prepares a person to benefit from practical and verbal remembrance.
- It supports spiritual growth, perfection and ultimate felicity.
- Spiritual tranquillity is a principal effect; the source describes release from causes of trepidation and anxiety.

Why the special student returned with his apple

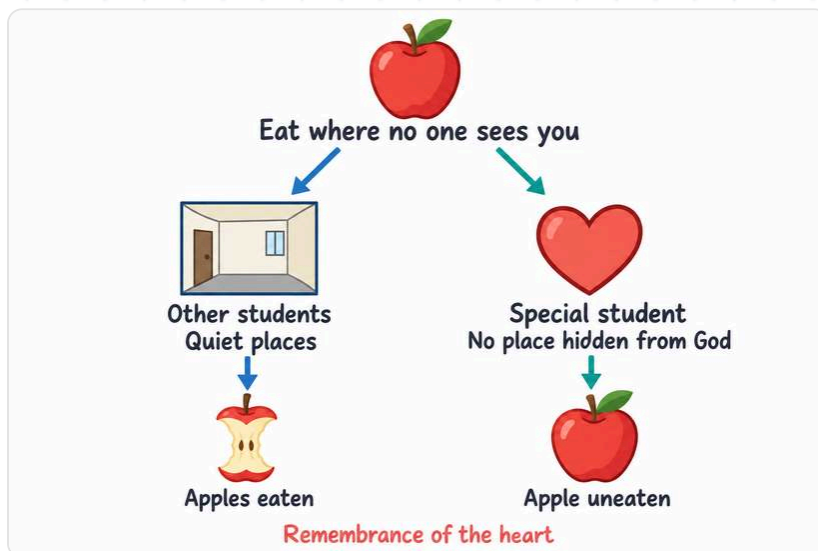


Fig. 20 The uneaten apple distinguishes absence of human observers from awareness of God's observation.

- The teacher asked each student to eat an apple somewhere no one could see them.
- The other students found quiet places, ate their apples and returned.
- The special student returned without eating his apple.
- He explained: "However, I did not find a place where God could not see me!"
- His classmates understood the teacher's special regard; the case illustrates awareness that one cannot escape God's observation.

Test yourself

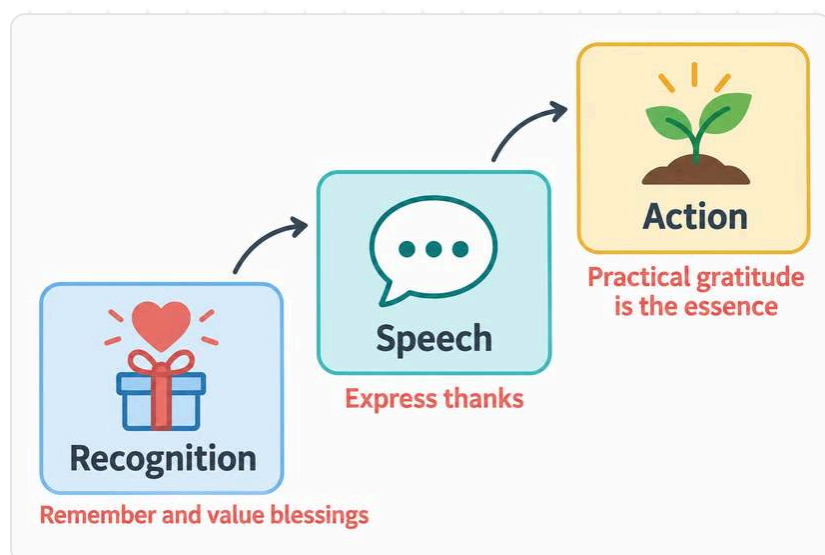
1. Why does the special student return without eating the apple?
 - A. He finds no place outside God's awareness
 - B. He could not find a physically private room
 - C. He was told that eating apples is prohibited
 - D. He was waiting for other students to praise him
2. Someone recites remembered words but gives no attention to their meaning or implications for conduct. Which priority in this page helps identify the gap?
 - A. The claim that remembrance is only a planning technique
 - B. The centrality of inward remembrance that supports practical and verbal expression
 - C. The requirement that all remembrance be publicly visible
 - D. The claim that words automatically replace inward awareness
3. A student refuses to cheat even when no classmate or invigilator can see. Which feature connects this scenario to the apple case?
 - A. Certainty that a hidden invigilator is present
 - B. A desire to be praised for avoiding detection
 - C. Proof that every quiet person is morally better
 - D. Conduct shaped by awareness beyond visible human observation

Answers: 1 A · 2 B · 3 D

Gratitude: recognition, speech and action

Recognize blessings, express thanks, and use each blessing in a way pleasing to God.

Three levels of gratitude



- Recognition: remember blessings and appreciate their value; this fosters love for God, their giver.
- Speech: express thanks verbally; the page recommends al-hamdu lillah and shukran lillah, especially during the prostration of thankfulness.
- Action: use blessings in ways pleasing to God; practical thankfulness is the most important level and the essence of gratitude.
- God needs no one and nothing; thanking Him is itself a blessing for the person progressing spiritually.

Fig. 21 Gratitude proceeds from recognizing blessings to expressing thanks and using blessings well.

Distinguish the three levels

LEVEL	WHAT IT REQUIRES	EXAM DISTINCTION
Recognition	Remember blessings and understand their worth.	Recognition encourages love for the giver.
Speech	Express thanks verbally.	Verbal thanks is one level; gratitude also requires action.
Action	Use blessings in ways pleasing to God.	The most important level and essence of gratitude.

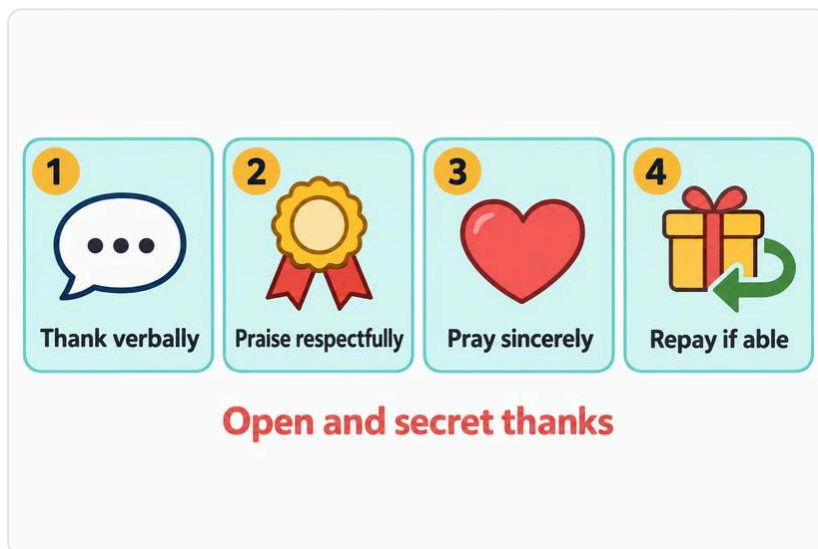
Practical gratitude: six source examples



- Speech: speak good words; avoid backbiting, slandering and snitching on others.
- Vision: avoid looking at what God has forbidden.
- Feet: avoid going to places where people sin.
- Beauty: remain chaste.
- Wealth: avoid wastefulness and help the poor and needy.
- Knowledge and a learned trade: serve God's creation.

Fig. 22 Each blessing has a corresponding practical expression of thanks.

Thanking a human benefactor



- Thank the person verbally for the good received.
- Praise the benefactor respectfully and sincerely pray to God for them; the narration describes open and secret thanks.
- Repay the kindness later if able; gratitude is connected with the benefactor's rights.

Fig. 23 The source links gratitude to the rights of someone who has done good for us.

Gratitude and increased blessings

- The page identifies increased blessings as one of gratitude's most important effects.
- "If you are thankful, then I will increase you [that is, your blessings]."
- The page contrasts gratitude with ingratitude, which leads to the blessing being taken away.

Thankfulness itself calls for thanks



- The ability to thank God is itself a blessing; each expression of gratitude calls for another.
- “How can I be thankful to You, when my thankfulness to You requires thanking.”
- “Thus, every time that I say, ‘Thank You,’ it becomes obligatory upon me to thank You again for this saying!”
- This continuing chain means human beings cannot thank God as He deserves.

Fig. 24 The ability to give thanks becomes another reason for gratitude.

Grateful words accompany restraint

- Imam Ja’far ibn Muhammad al-Sadiq (A) links gratitude with avoiding prohibited actions.
- “Thanking God for a blessing necessitates that one stay away from prohibited things”
- “and perfect gratitude is to say, ‘All thanks is due to God, the Lord of the Worlds’”

Test yourself

1. A person gives thanks for the ability to speak and then avoids slander while speaking constructively. Which level is most directly shown by the behavior?
A. Recognition only
B. Verbal thanks only
C. Ostentation necessarily
D. Practical thankfulness
2. Why is using a learned skill to serve others an example of practical gratitude?
A. It applies a received ability beneficially rather than merely praising its existence
B. Because useful action makes all intentions irrelevant
C. Because possessing knowledge alone completes gratitude
D. Because the helper is owed unlimited public praise
3. Which response best matches practical thankfulness for wealth in the supplied list?
A. Refuse all gratitude to people involved in earning or giving it
B. Avoid waste and help poor or needy people
C. Repeat thanks while deliberately wasting resources
D. Treat wealth as proof of superior moral worth

Answers: 1 D · 2 A · 3 B

Gratitude: obstacles and distinctions

Learn the five obstacles and distinguish receiving blessings from responding to them gratefully.

Five obstacles to gratitude



- Failing to recognize blessings already received.
- Recognizing blessings, then forgetting them.
- Envy the resources given to others.
- Being greedy and dissatisfied with what one has.
- Holding a negative perspective on life generally.

Fig. 25 The five obstacles are distinct attitudes that hinder gratitude.

Do not confuse the obstacles

OBSTACLE	DISTINGUISHING FEATURE
Nonrecognition	The blessing is not recognized in the first place.
Forgetfulness	A recognized blessing is subsequently forgotten.
Envy	Attention centres on resources given to others.
Greed and dissatisfaction	One remains dissatisfied with one's own resources.
Negative outlook	The negative attitude concerns life generally.

Two responses within faith

- The page presents patience and gratefulness as two branches of faith.
- Patience is the servant's response to difficulties; thankfulness is the faithful response to blessings.
- "And few of My servants are grateful" (34:13).

Receiving blessings does not prove felicity

- God's general mercy includes good and bad people; some bounties are universal, while others are specific to righteous believers.
- Continued blessings without gratitude may increase forgetfulness and sin; receiving them alone does not establish felicity.
- The page describes deliberate opponents of known truth misusing blessings, increasing their sins and punishment in the next world.
- Recognizing God's right and striving to be thankful distinguish the grateful response.

Source case: a rejected blessing



- At Mina, Imam al-Sadiq (A) offers a beggar grapes; the beggar rejects them and asks for coins.
- The beggar returns asking for the grapes, but the Imam does not give them to him.
- The supplied case illustrates rejecting an offered blessing; no further events from this case are supplied.

Fig. 26 The supplied portion of the case follows an offered gift, its rejection, and an unsuccessful return.

Test yourself

- Which pairing expresses the two responses contrasted on printed page 49?

A. Envy in difficulty and pride in abundance	B. Idleness in difficulty and waste in abundance
C. Silence in every circumstance and avoidance of all action	D. Patience in difficulty and gratitude for blessings
- A person appreciated a friend's help at first but later treats it as if it never occurred. Which listed obstacle is most specific?

A. Never recognizing any benefit at any point	B. Practical thankfulness
C. Reflection on the value of time	D. Forgetting an acknowledged blessing
- Which item is an obstacle to gratitude explicitly listed on printed page 49?

A. Using knowledge to help others	B. Sincere acknowledgment of a benefactor
C. Recognizing a blessing and later forgetting it	D. Recognizing the worth of a blessing

Answers: 1 D • 2 D • 3 C

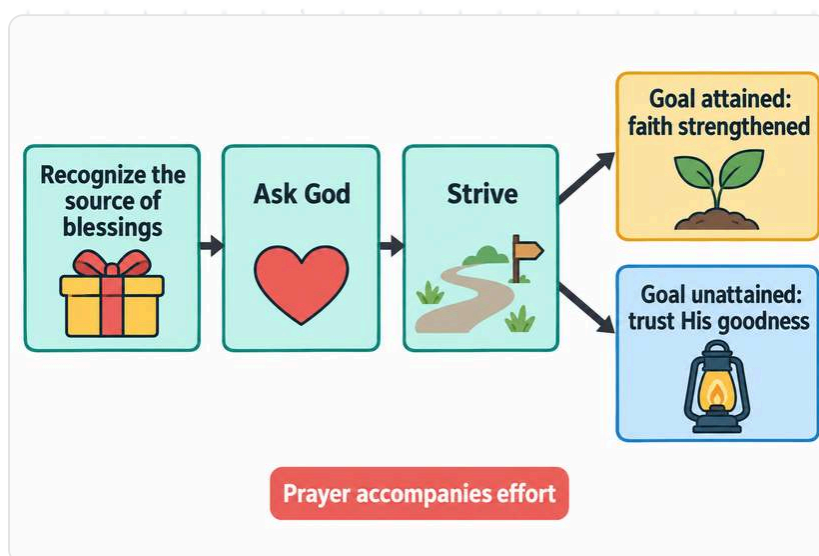
Prayer, effort and a wise response

Dua joins recognition of God's provision with effort and trust in His wisdom.

Prayer: two Quranic excerpts

- قُلْ مَا يَعْجَبُ بِكُمْ رَبِّي لَوْلَا دُعَاؤُكُمْ
- "Say: If it were not for your prayers then God would not care for you at all" (25:77).
- ادْعُونِي أَسْتَجِبْ لَكُمْ
- "Pray to Me; I will answer you" (40:60).

Knowledge of God leads to prayer and effort



- God possesses every perfection; all material and spiritual benefits originate from Him.
- The believer asks God for needs and wishes, then strives to achieve them.
- Experiencing divine help in achieving a goal strengthens faith.
- If the goal is not attained, the believer remains confident that the beneficent God desires good for His servants.

Fig. 27 The source joins asking and striving with trust in God through either outcome.

Five effects of prayer listed on the page



- Remembrance of God, proximity to Him and His love.
- Protection from problems and difficulties that might afflict a person.
- Salvation from enemies.
- Increased sustenance.
- Purification from sins.

Fig. 28 The page lists five effects of prayer.

An answer may differ from the requested outcome



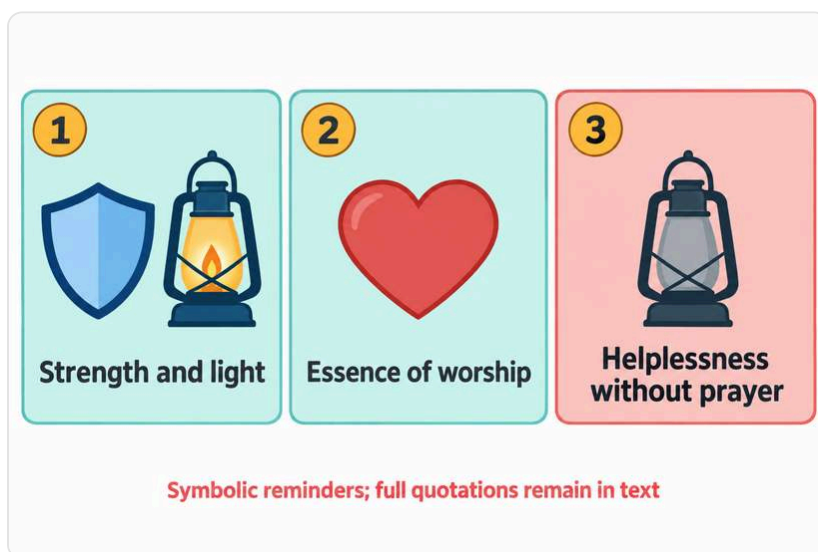
- God acts according to His wisdom and fulfils needs through material or supernatural means.
- A prayer may not be answered in the manner expected; the page gives lack of effort as one possible reason.
- The poverty example also explains that becoming rich may bring wretchedness; wisdom can therefore withhold the desired outcome.
- The source compares this with a mother refusing her child a knife; the continuation of that analogy is absent.

Fig. 29 The poverty example distinguishes effort, expectations, welfare and the means of response.

Prayer and the expected result

DISTINCTION	WHAT THE SOURCE TEACHES
Asking versus striving	The believer asks God and then works toward the goal.
Desired result versus wise response	The requested outcome may not be good for the requester.
Lack of effort versus harmful outcome	Both appear in the poverty example; neither is presented as an exhaustive explanation.
Material versus supernatural means	The source allows both as means through which needs are fulfilled.

Three narrations on prayer



- The Prophet (S): “Prayers are the weapon of the believer and the light of the heavens and the earth”.
- The Prophet (S): “Prayer is the essence of worship. No one will be destroyed if he continues to pray”.
- Imam al-Husayn ibn Ali (A): “The most helpless of people is the one who cannot pray”.

Fig. 30 The three narrations emphasize prayer’s strength, centrality and the helplessness of being unable to pray.

Test yourself

1. Why can the believer's hope remain when the particular objective is not attained, according to the supplied argument?
 - A. All stated objectives are irrelevant to practical life
 - B. Divine goodness and wisdom are not reduced to fulfillment of that one desire
 - C. The person must deny that any effort was required
 - D. Every non-attainment proves the person secretly wanted failure
2. Through which means does the page say a response to prayer may occur?
 - A. Only money transferred immediately
 - B. Only through complete abandonment of action
 - C. Material or supernatural means, according to divine wisdom
 - D. Only a visible miracle
3. A requested outcome does not occur. Which conclusion is compatible with the page's account without pretending to know the particular reason?
 - A. A wise response need not be identical to the requested outcome
 - B. The requester must have committed a specific hidden sin
 - C. God must have failed to hear the request
 - D. Every request is therefore meaningless

Answers: 1 B · 2 C · 3 A

Gratitude, prayer and repentance

10

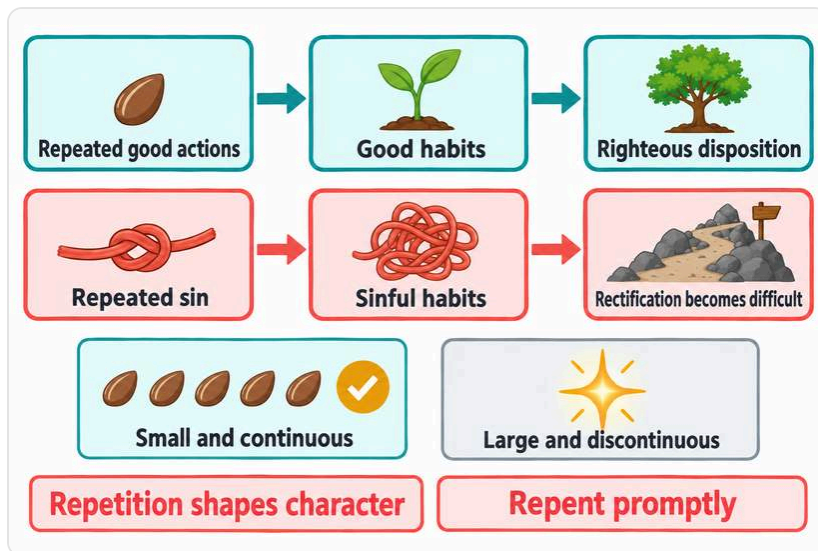
Immediate repentance and moral development

Delay strengthens sinful habits; repentance and repeated good actions shape the person while life continues.

Repent at the first opportunity

- The page attributes mistakes to the devil's insinuations and the carnal soul's instigation; repentance is the person's responsibility.
- Do not let sins accumulate: evil actions can take root and distance a person from God's light.
- The source compares sin to a disease of the soul and repentance to its medicine.
- No one is guaranteed another hour or minute of life; therefore repentance must not be postponed.

Repetition shapes habits and character



- Repeated actions become habits, whether the actions are good or bad.
- Continued sin and delayed repentance affect behaviour, take root in the soul and change personality.
- Once sinful patterns are established, abandoning sin, rectification and repentance become very difficult.
- Strengthening good spiritual habits likewise shapes disposition; the page especially urges vigilance among young people.
- Imam Ali (A): "The action that is small but continues is better than the action that is big but does not continue."

Fig. 31 Repeated good or bad actions become habits and shape disposition.

Habit and persistence

PATTERN	SOURCE TEACHING
Repeated good actions	Good spiritual habits strengthen and shape disposition.
Repeated sin with delayed repentance	Sin takes root; abandoning it and rectifying behaviour become difficult.
Small continuous action	The quoted narration prefers it to a large action that does not continue.

Repentance belongs to this life

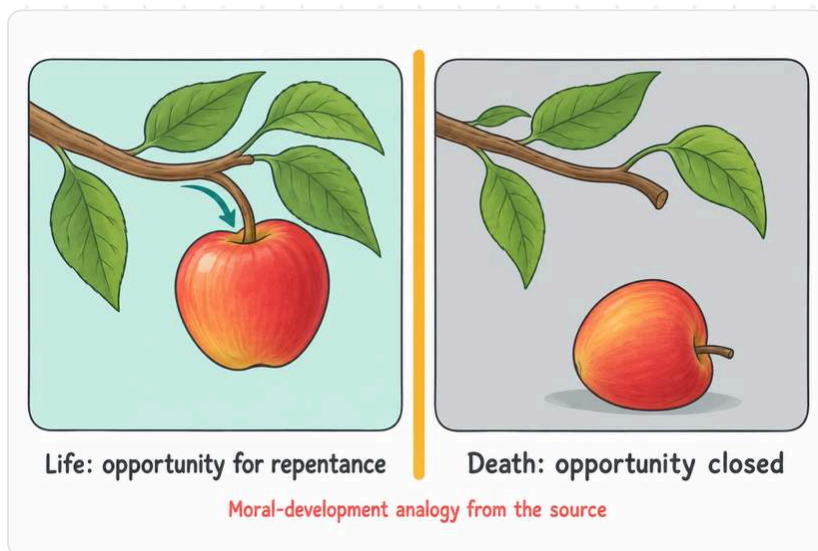


Fig. 32 The source's fruit analogy places moral development and repentance within life.

- The page states that repentance closes at death and afterwards; good deeds and unrepented bad deeds become permanently recorded.
- Mutahhari's explanation: seeing punishment after death does not produce a true spiritual revolution.
- The source compares a living person with fruit still attached to its tree: nourishment can still support ripening.
- Repentance nourishes moral development while alive; death ends that opportunity, like fruit becoming detached from the tree.

Test yourself

1. Which pair best captures the page's two arguments against postponing repentance?
 - A. Only public mistakes matter, and private acts leave no effect
 - B. Good conduct must be dramatic, and small acts are worthless
 - C. Wrongdoing can become entrenched, and future time before death is uncertain
 - D. All habits are unchangeable, and everyone knows their exact time of death
2. Why does the discussion value a small continuing good action over a large act that is not sustained?
 - A. Repeated good action can form a stable constructive habit
 - B. Magnitude never matters in any ethical judgment
 - C. A dramatic act always erases every future responsibility
 - D. Continuity is relevant only to bad habits
3. What does fruit ripening while attached to its tree illustrate in the cited account?
 - A. A claim that all people become good without choices
 - B. The opportunity for moral development while earthly life continues
 - C. A literal biological description of the human soul
 - D. A guarantee that postponement improves repentance

Answers: 1 C • 2 A • 3 B

Integrated distinctions for revision

Compare intention, dependence, awareness, response to blessings, supplication and moral repair using the supplied teaching pages.

Six virtues: what each addresses

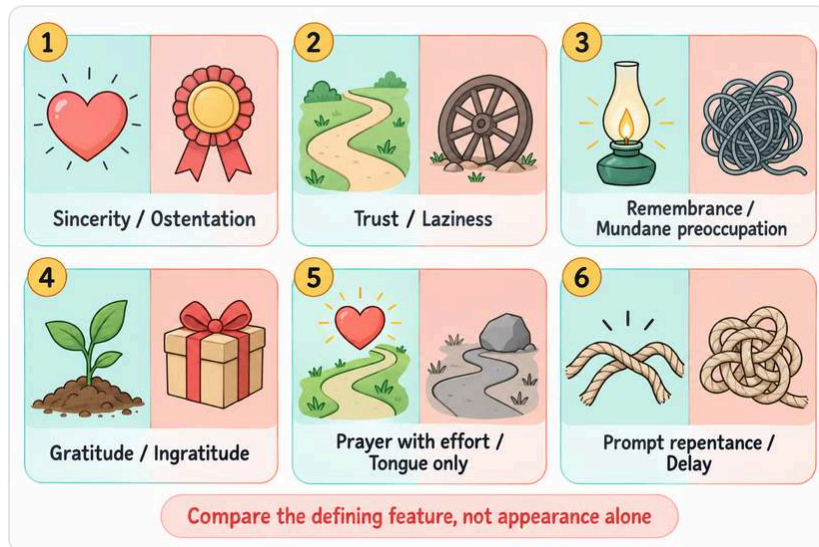


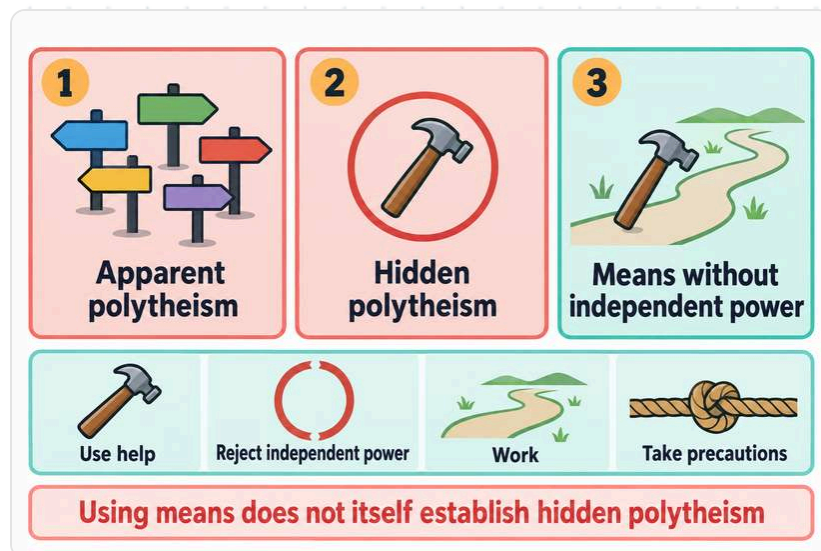
Fig. 33 Each topic tests a different feature of moral practice.

- Sincerity purifies intention; ostentation seeks worldly recognition or benefits through apparently good deeds.
- Trust relies on God while exerting effort; laziness abandons responsibility under the claim of reliance.
- Remembrance of the heart counters preoccupation with the mundane and supports verbal and practical remembrance.
- Gratitude recognizes blessings, expresses thanks and uses gifts well; its obstacles hinder that response.
- Prayer asks God while striving and trusting His wisdom; merely praying with the tongue can accompany failure to exert effort.
- Repentance responds promptly to sin; postponement allows sinful habits to take root.

Related virtues and their contrasts

VIRTUE	CENTRAL CONCERN	CONTRAST OR EXAM PITFALL	SOURCE PDF PAGE
Sincerity	Whose pleasure motivates the deed?	Ostentation can poison an outwardly correct action.	6–7
Trust	On whom does one ultimately rely?	Taking means is compatible with trust; idleness is not.	8, 13
Remembrance	What occupies the heart?	Heartfelt remembrance grounds verbal and practical remembrance.	9
Gratitude	How does one respond to blessings?	Words alone omit the most important level: obedient use.	10–12
Prayer	How are needs sought?	Asking accompanies striving; the expected outcome may not be wise.	14
Repentance	How does one respond to sin?	Delay makes correction harder and risks losing the opportunity at death.	15

Using means versus treating them as independent



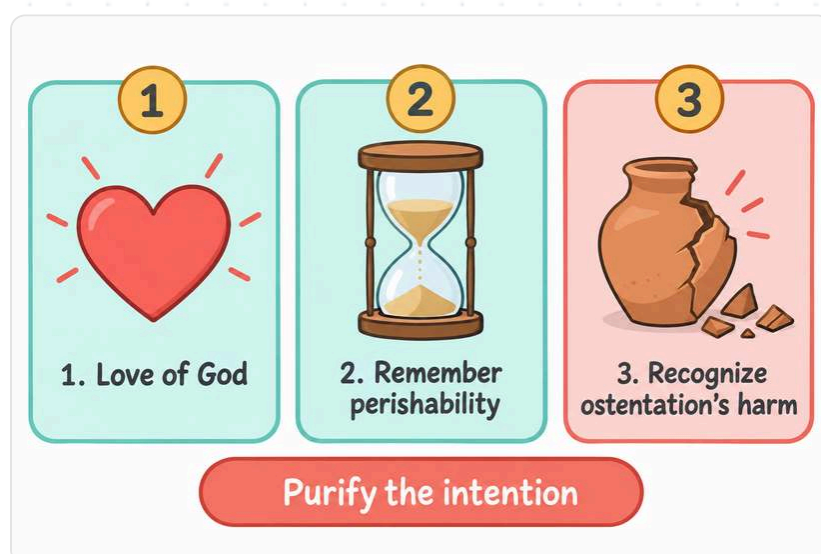
- Apparent polytheism: belief in more than one God and worship directed to beings other than God.
- Hidden polytheism: belief in one God alongside belief that other beings act independently of Him.
- The true monotheist may seek human help and use natural causes while denying that these can independently secure needs.
- Trust is rooted in certainty about divine unity; water, food and medicine illustrate causes whose abilities depend on God.

Fig. 34 The decisive distinction is belief in independent power, not simply making use of help.

Belief and use of causes

CASE	SOURCE DISTINCTION
Using another person's help	Permissible within the source's account of true monotheism; help is not independently effective.
Treating another being as independently effective	The page's definition of hidden polytheism.
Avoiding work while claiming trust	The farming example is identified as laziness.
Trusting while taking precautions	The camel narration joins tying the camel with trust in God.

Sincerity: three changes of outlook



- Cultivate love of God; pure love directs ambitions toward the beloved.
- Reflect on the perishability of everything besides God; remembering death, graves and unexpected accidents helps this outlook.
- Recognize that ostentation nullifies and poisons a deed, gradually drawing the person toward polytheism.

Fig. 35 The first three source practices reshape what the person values and seeks.

Sincerity: four further practices

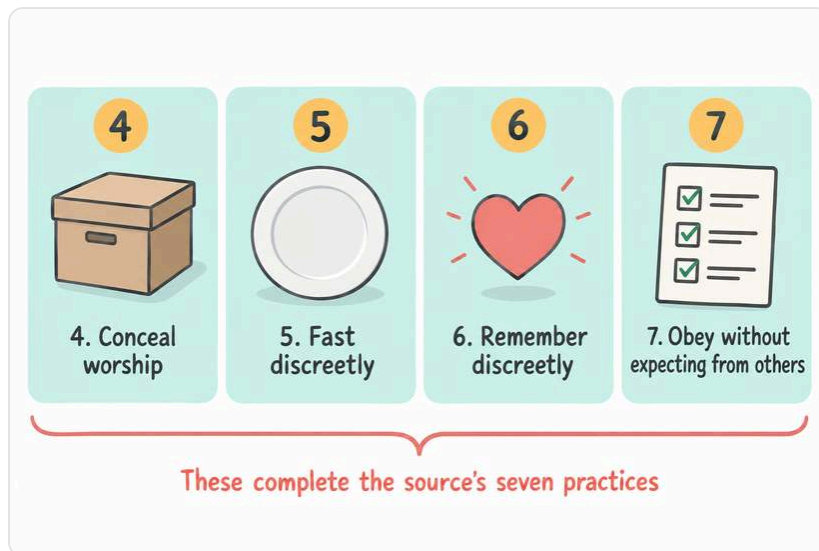


Fig. 36 The remaining four practices combine concealed worship with a sense of duty.

Five signs of trust

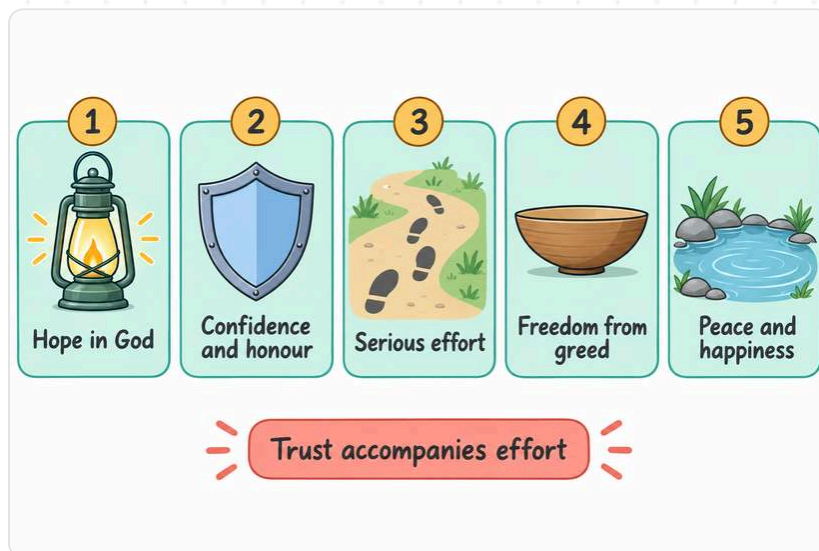
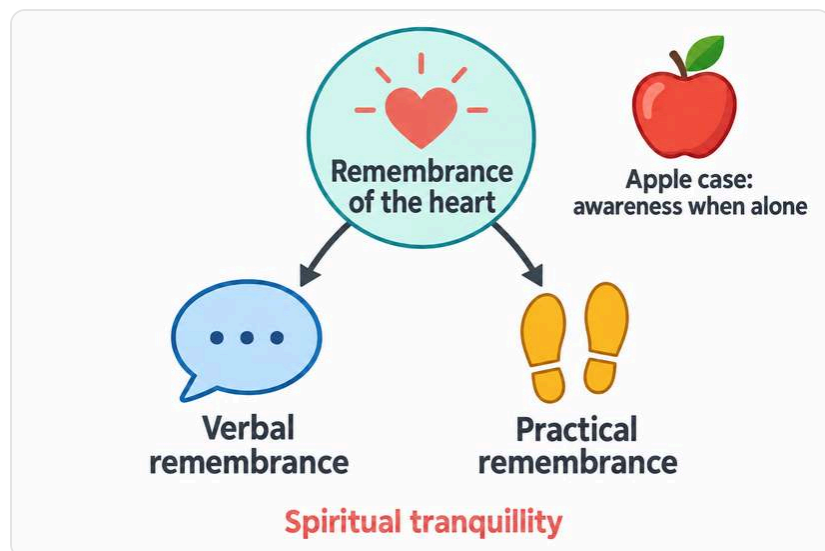


Fig. 37 Serious effort is itself one of the five signs of trust.

- Conceal acts of worship rather than telling others, including close friends or family.
- Practise sincerity through fasting, which others need not know about unless the person tells them.
- The page recommends la ilaha illa Allah as remembrance that can remain unnoticed because the lips do not meet.
- Obedience and avoiding prohibitions are duties whose benefits return to the person; do not expect something from others.

- Think well of God, rely on Him and hope in what is with Him; do not fix hopes on others' possessions.
- Have confidence and honour without fear of others or difficulties.
- Make a serious effort to attain life's goals.
- Avoid greed and sadness about sustenance.
- Maintain peace and happiness.

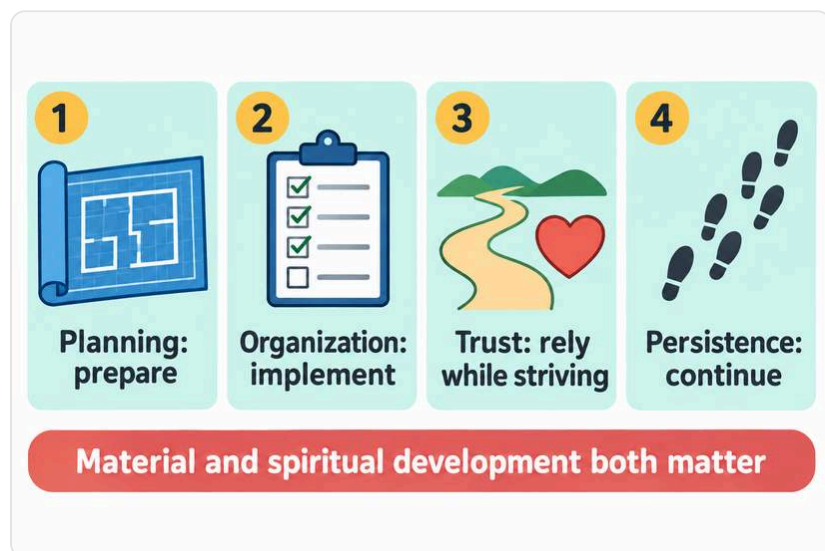
The heart supports words and actions



- The page identifies remembrance of the heart as the most important kind and the basis for benefiting from verbal and practical remembrance.
- Remembrance frees the heart from mundane attachment, supports spiritual growth and perfection, and brings tranquillity and felicity.
- In the apple case, the favoured student leaves his apple uneaten because he cannot find any place unseen by God.
- The case tests awareness beyond human observation; being alone does not remove that awareness.

Fig. 38 Heartfelt remembrance supports verbal and practical remembrance.

Planning and organization support effort



- The diamond-bank analogy presents the 86,400 seconds of each day as precious time that cannot be given back.
- Planning means conceptualizing and preparing a good plan; organization means implementing it and securing its success.
- The source joins material and spiritual development; seriousness in worldly responsibilities supports seriousness about the afterlife.

Fig. 39 Planning, organization, trust and persistence address different aspects of action.

Plan, act, trust and persist

TERM	DISTINCT ROLE	SOURCE PDF PAGE
Planning	Conceptualize and prepare the plan.	4
Organization	Implement the plan and secure its success.	4
Trust	Rely on God while using means and exerting effort.	8, 13
Persistence	Repeated actions form habits; small continuous action is preferred to large discontinuous action.	15

Four principles of planning

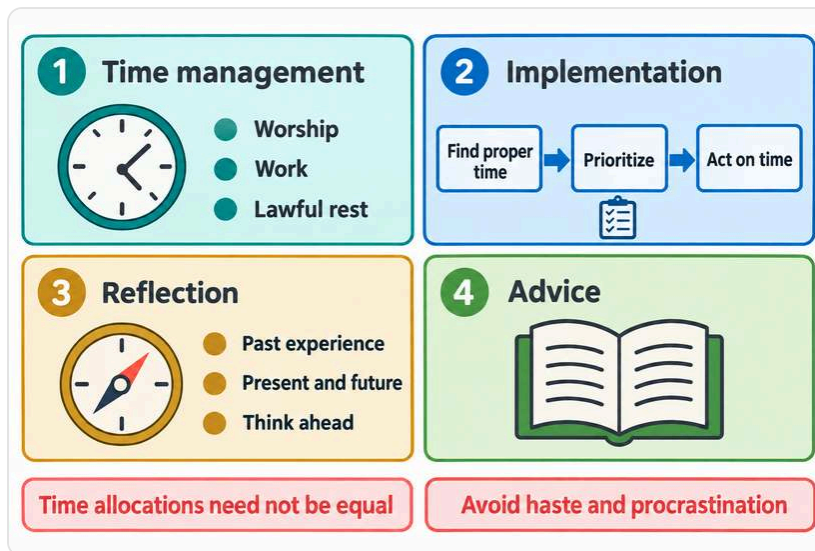


Fig. 40 The four planning principles connect balanced time use with timely action, reflection and advice.

- Time management: allow time for worship, work and lawful rest; allocations follow needs and priorities, not necessarily equal periods.
- Implementation: recognize the proper time, prioritize tasks and carry them out then; avoid haste, procrastination and missed opportunities.
- Reflection: examine past experience, attend to present and future, and think ahead before acting.
- Advice: seek knowledgeable, experienced mentors, including parents, religious scholars or specialist counsellors.

Four characteristics of a good plan



Fig. 41 The supplied page lists four characteristics of a good plan.

- Define goals clearly and establish their priorities.
- Make the steps harmonious with the goals they are meant to achieve.
- Include and prioritize responsibilities, activities and necessary requirements comprehensively.
- Balance capabilities and desires: goals arise from needs, while capabilities provide the means to reach them.

Sources

Divine Ethics reference PDF p.1 (printed p.5) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.2 (printed p.6) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.3 (printed p.7) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.4 (printed p.59) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.5 (printed p.60) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.6 (printed p.56) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.7 (printed p.58) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.8 (printed p.52) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.9 (printed p.32) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.10 (printed p.46) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.11 (printed p.47) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.12 (printed p.49) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.13 (printed p.54) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.14 (printed p.40) · Divine Ethics reference PDF p.15 (printed p.35) · Ghurar al-Hikam, p. 354, as quoted in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.4. · Awali al-Layali, vol. 1, p. 292, as quoted in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.5. · Tuhaf al-Uqul, p. 394, as quoted in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.5; excerpt ends before the explanation of beginning and finishing. · Nahj al-Balagha, Letter 53, as quoted in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.4; wording retained from the supplied translation. · al-Kafi, vol. 9, p. 560, as printed in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.5; the cited work was not independently supplied. · Musadarak al-Wasa'il and Mustambat al-Wasa'il, vol. 11, p. 217, spelling as printed in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.8. · Sunan al-Tirmidhi, vol. 4, p. 76, tradition 2636, as printed in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.13. · Mishkat al-Anwar fi Ghurar al-Akhbar, p. 18, as quoted in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.8. · Ghurar al-Hikam, p. 197, tradition 3888, as quoted in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.13; the second point is an exact excerpt. · Qur'an 40:60, Arabic excerpt and English meaning as printed in Divine Ethics reference PDF p.14 (printed p.40). · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.10 (printed p.46) · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.11 (printed p.47) · Benefactor narration as cited on printed p.47: Wasa'il al-Shi'ah, vol. 11, p. 136; paraphrased here. · English Quranic quotation as printed on p.47; this page supplies neither Arabic nor a verse number. · Imam Ali ibn al-Husayn al-Sajjad (A), Prayer of the Thankful: Zad al-Ma'ad, Munajat 6, p. 410, as cited on printed p.47; consecutive English excerpts. · al-Kafi, vol. 3, p. 246, as cited on printed p.47; consecutive English excerpts from one narration, not an Arabic reconstruction. · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.12 (printed p.49) · Quran 34:13: English excerpt exactly as printed on p.49; Arabic is not supplied on this page. · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.14 (printed p.40) · Quran 25:77 and 40:60: only the Arabic excerpts and English meanings printed on p.40 are reproduced, not the complete verses. · First narration: al-Kafi, vol. 4, p. 301, as cited on printed p.40. · Second narration: Bihar al-Anwar, vol. 90, p. 300, as cited on printed p.40. · Third narration: Bihar al-Anwar, vol. 90, p. 294, as cited on printed p.40. All three are supplied only in English. · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.15 (printed p.35) · Imam Ali (A), discussion activity on printed p.35: English narration supplied without a collection reference or Arabic text. · Case study attributed on printed p.35 to Ayatollah Mortaza Mutahhari; no work title is given. The analogy is paraphrased. · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.6 (printed p.56) · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.7 (printed p.58) · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.8 (printed p.52) · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.9 (printed p.32) · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.13 (printed p.54) · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.4 (printed p.59) · Divine Ethics reference, PDF p.5 (printed p.60)